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City of McKinney — Library Technician, Community Engagement — Supplemental Answer

Describe a time you helped make an experience better, more fun or more meaningful for other people. What did you do, how did it turn out, and what did you enjoy about it?

At the University of Austin I was the person who showed visitors the campus library. It began as a small piece of a development job, essentially walking guests from one room to the next, and the first few were flat. People were polite and quietly bored.

What changed it was realising they did not want a tour of a building, they wanted to be let in on something. So I stopped reciting what was where and started opening things. We had received a complete Harvard Classics set as a donation, and rather than gesturing at the shelf I would pull a volume down and hand it to someone. People are different with a book actually in their hands. I learned which items had a story attached and built the walk around those instead of around the floor plan, and I started asking early on what a visitor was interested in so I could bend the route toward it.

The tours got longer, which was the clearest signal that something had shifted. People stayed and asked questions instead of edging toward the exit, and several asked to come back and bring someone with them. Colleagues began sending guests to me specifically.

What I enjoyed was the moment someone stopped being a visitor and started being curious. It is a visible change, and once you have caused it a few times you start designing for it rather than hoping for it. That is also what drew me to this role: community engagement is that same problem at a larger scale, which is giving people a reason to walk in and something worth staying for.

The rest of my work is the machinery behind that. I run printed campaigns end to end, coordinating vendors and partners, holding schedules together across several concurrent projects, producing the promotional material, and reporting afterward on whether any of it worked. Programming needs both halves, the idea and the logistics, and I am comfortable on either side.

This answer is effectively the cover letter for McKinney. It is the only required supplemental question and the posting asks what you ENJOYED, which is a culture screen. Keep the warmth; do not trim it into a list of duties.